

Open Source Flourished. So Did Its Dependence on Proprietary Infrastructure?

*“Governance, Git Hosting, and the Future of
FOSS Infrastructure”*

Speaker



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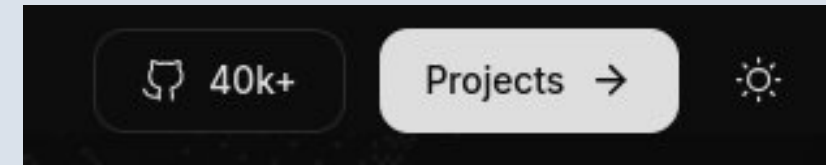
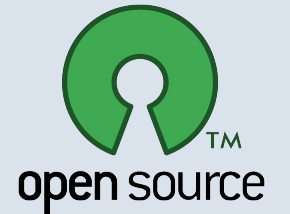
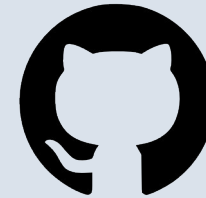
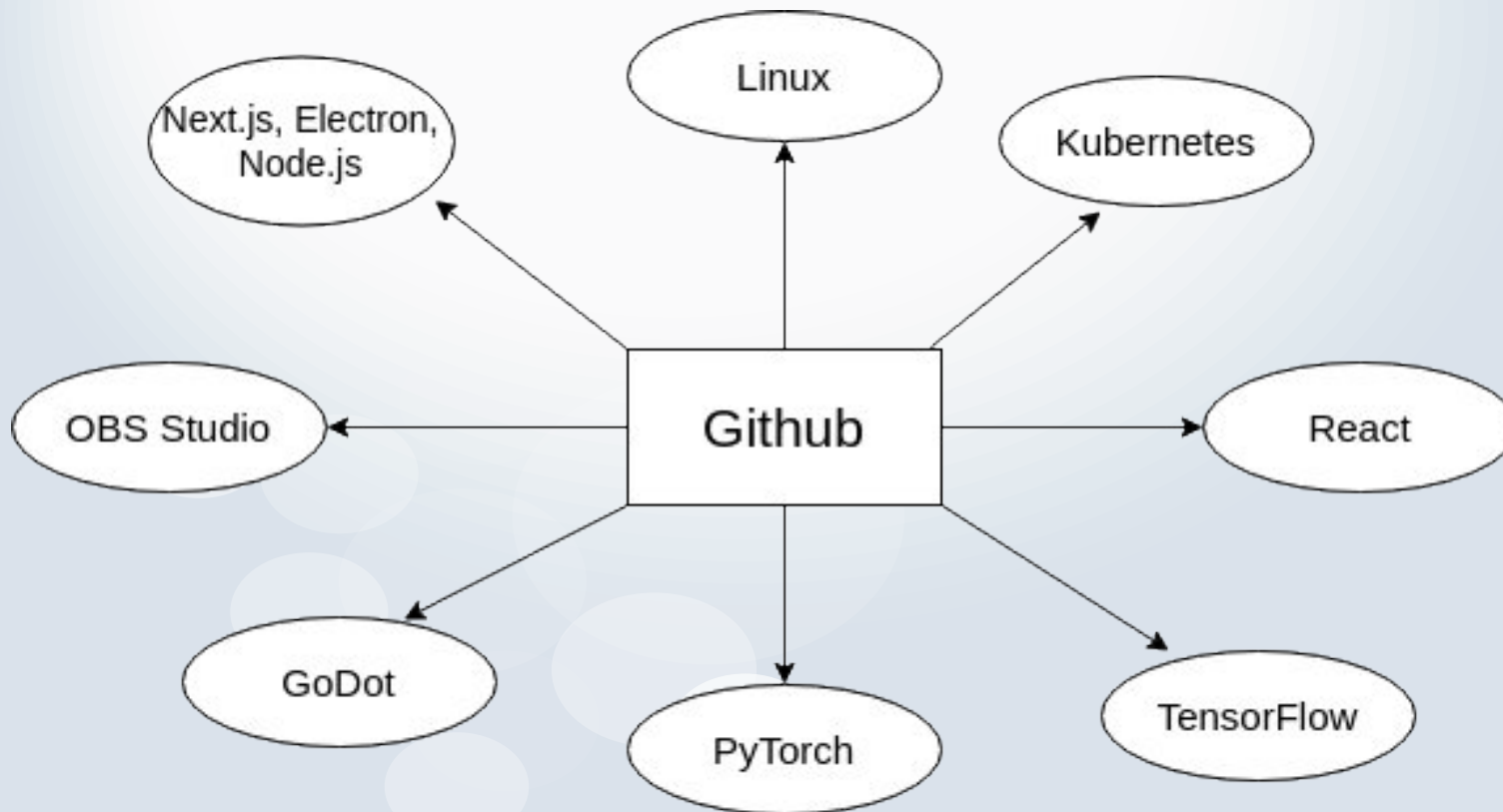
What is Git !?

- Git is a distributed version control system.
- Git is decentralized by design
- It provides the core mechanics of collaboration:
 - commits (snapshots of changes)
 - branches (parallel work)
 - merges (combining work)
 - remotes (sharing repositories between systems)



The Irony

- Github was the first Git based Collaboration Platform, it transformed Git from a CLI tool to a social coding platform.
- GitHub became the default home for Open Source:



How GitHub Became the default Infrastructure

It provided Convenience:

- CI/CD → GitHub Actions
- Packages → GitHub Container Registry
- Authentication → “Sign in with GitHub”
- Documentation → GitHub Pages
- Community → GitHub Discussions

The Problem

- **Community Governance is Suppressed by Companies Interests**
 1. “GitHub retains full discretion to remove any content or terminate any accounts...”
 - One corporation ultimately controls access
 - Eg: [windows-exploit-researcher-suspended](#)
 2. “Downgrading the visibility of the offending content”
 - Which discussions are amplified,
 - Which repositories become visible to contributors.

The Problem

- **Automation Limits**

Modern OSS workflows rely on GitHub for:

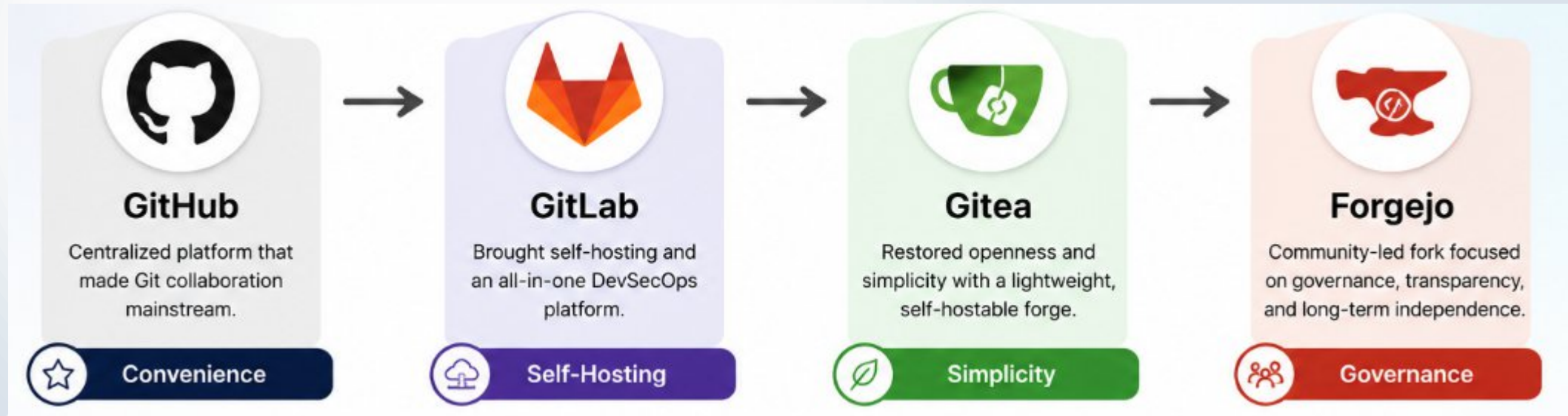
- CI/CD
- Testing
- Deployments
- Package publishing

- This creates a “Tier” Dependency & Vendor Lock-in.

Governance Models

Model	Controlled By	Example
Corporate-Led	Company	GitHub
Open Core	Company	GitLab
Community-Led	Non-profit/community	Forgejo

The Alternatives Story



GitLab, Gitea

- GitLab Provided:
 - Open-core development model
 - Self-hosting support
 - Built-in CI/CD
 - Full GitHub replacement

2014: GitLab Inc, was established to monetize the services built on top of open-core model.

Gitea was:

- Lightweight
- Fast
- Easy self-hosting

2022: The transition to vendorship began silently when Gitea's creators incorporated Gitea Ltd.

The Community Governed Tool

Forgejo: A Community Fork

- It was:
 - Lightweight
 - Git based
 - Self Hostable in minutes
 - Backed by German Non-Profit Organisation called Codeberg.

“ Forgejo embraced the idea that critical open-source infrastructure should belong to communities, not companies.”

Project	Open Source Model	Governance Structure
GitHub	Partial / Open components	Corporate (Microsoft)
GitLab	Open core	Corporate
Gitea	Open source	Company influence concerns
Forgejo	Open source (GPLv3)	Community / Non-profit aligned

Self Hosting Forgejo

Public Instances of ForgeJo

- codeberg.org:
 - German non-profit organization
 - Built and maintained using Forgejo
 - Community-funded and donation-supported
 - One of the largest public Forgejo instances
- Other Instances of ForgeJo

Project Migration from other platforms to ForgeJo

Migrate repository

 Git Migrate a repository only from any Git service.	 GitHub Migrate data from github.com or GitHub Enterprise server.	 GitLab Migrate data from gitlab.com or other GitLab instances.	 Forgejo Migrate data from codeberg.org or other Forgejo instances.
 Gitea Migrate data from gitea.com or other Gitea instances.	 Gogs Migrate data from notabug.org or other Gogs instances.	 OneDev Migrate data from code.onedev.io or other OneDev instances.	 GitBucket Migrate data from GitBucket instances.
 Codebase Migrate data from codebasehq.com.	 Pagure Migrate data from pagure.io or other Pagure instances.		

Federation & future vision

The emerging vision:

- Community-owned forge instances
- Federated collaboration between platforms
- Reduced dependence on a single provider
- Self-hosting becoming easier than ever

Conclusion

Steps that individuals and Communities can take:

- Try self-hosting our own forge
- Support non-profit infrastructure
- Contribute to Forgejo & Codeberg

Questions/Perspectives/Thoughts/Discussions ?